

The variations as between the different regions, as indicated above, are distinctly smaller than they were prior to 1920. The maintenance expenditures of numerous roads fell conspicuously below the above standards during 1931 and 1932. For example, the Illinois Central ratios for 1932 were as follows: maintenance of way, 8.36%; maintenance of equipment, 19.48%.

Sharp differences as between roads in the same geographical district also developed, as is indicated by the following:

Year and road	Maintenance of way, % of gross	Maintenance of equipment, % of gross	Total, % of gross
1926–1930 average for Southwestern region	15.85	17.97	33.82
Atchison:			
1929	15.79	18.13	33.92
1932	11.52	23.69	35.21
St. Louis—Southwestern:			
1929	19.97	16.26	36.24
1932	14.65	16.87	31.52
Southern Pacific:			
1929	12.63	17.46	30.09
1932	11.86	18.57	30.43

The following study contrasts the trend of maintenance for various groups of roads classified in accordance with their financial situation:

Item	Total maintenance ratio, %		
	1928	1934	1938
17 roads paying dividends in 1938	34.5	32.2	32.0
23 solvent roads not paying dividends in 1938	32.2	30.0	29.8
21 roads insolvent in 1938	32.6	32.3	33.0
All Class I roads	32.8	30.7	30.7

This comparison shows, first, that dividend-paying roads tend to be more liberal with maintenance than nondividend payers struggling to remain solvent and, second, that roads falling into trusteeship tend to increase their maintenance ratios even while the others are cutting down.